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User Templates

Noctalia allows you to create custom templates to theme any application that supports configuration files. Your templates automatically update whenever you change your color scheme.

Getting Started

1. Enable User Templates

1. Go to **Settings → Color Scheme → Templates**
2. Scroll to **Advanced** section
3. Enable **User templates**
4. A configuration file will be created at `~/.config/noctalia/user-templates.toml`

2. Create Your Template File

Create a template file anywhere you like, for example `~/.config/noctalia/templates/myapp.css`:

```
/* Example CSS template */  
.my-app {  
  background: {{colors.surface.default.hex}};  
  color: {{colors.on_surface.default.hex}};  
  accent: {{colors.primary.default.hex}};  
  border: 1px solid {{colors.outline.default.hex}};  
}
```

3. Register Your Template

Full documentation for the user templates system.

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```
[config]

[templates.myapp]
input_path = "~/.config/noctalia/templates/myapp.css"
output_path = "~/.config/myapp/theme.css"
post_hook = "notify-send 'myapp templated'"
```

Properties:

- **input_path** - Path to your template file
- **output_path** - Where to write the generated theme
- **post_hook** - Optional command to run after generation (e.g., reload app)

Your template will now be processed automatically whenever the theme changes.

Template Syntax

Templates use the syntax `{{colors.name.mode.format}}`:

- **name**: The color name (e.g., primary, surface, on_surface)
- **mode**: default, dark, or light. Use default to follow the system theme.
- **format**: Output format (see below)

Output Formats

Format	Example Output
hex	#FF5733
hex_stripped	FF5733
rgb	rgb(255, 87, 51)

Format

Example Output

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rgba	rgba(255, 87, 51, 1.0)
hsl	hsl(14, 100%, 60%)
hsla	hsla(14, 100%, 60%, 1.0)
red, green, blue	Individual RGB values (0-255)
hue, saturation, lightness	Individual HSL values
alpha	Alpha value (0.0-1.0)

Available Colors

Noctalia generates a complete 48-color Material Design 3 palette:

- Primary Colors (8)
- Secondary Colors (8)
- Tertiary Colors (8)
- Error Colors (4)
- Surface Colors (11)
- Outline & Utility Colors (4)
- Inverse Colors (3)
- Background Colors (2)

Filters

Modify colors using filters with the | syntax:

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```
overlay = {{colors.surface.default.hex | set_alpha 0.8}}
muted = {{colors.error.default.hex | grayscale}}
```

Chain multiple filters:

```
highlight = {{colors.primary.default.hex | lighten 10 | set_alpha 0.9}}
```

Color Filters

Filter	Argument	Description
grayscale	none	Convert to grayscale
invert	none	Invert the color
lighten	percentage (0-100)	Increase lightness
darken	percentage (0-100)	Decrease lightness
saturate	percentage (0-100)	Increase saturation
desaturate	percentage (0-100)	Decrease saturation
set_alpha	float (0.0-1.0)	Set alpha/opacity
set_lightness	percentage (0-100)	Set absolute lightness
set_saturation	percentage (0-100)	Set absolute saturation
set_hue	degrees (0-360)	Set absolute hue
set_red	value (0-255)	Set red channel
set_green	value (0-255)	Set green channel
set_blue	value (0-255)	Set blue channel

Filter	Argument	Description
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blend	"#hex", amount	Blend hue toward target color
harmonize	"#hex"	M3 harmonize (max 15° hue shift)

String Filters

Filter	Description
lower_case	Convert to lowercase
camel_case	Convert to camelCase
pascal_case	Convert to PascalCase
snake_case	Convert to snake_case
kebab_case	Convert to kebab-case
replace: "find", "replace"	String replacement

Advanced Features

Block Constructs

Use control flow blocks with `<* ... *>` syntax:

For Loops

```
<* for name, value in colors *>
  --color-{{name}}: {{value.default.hex}};
<* endfor *>
```

Available iterables:

- colors - All 48 color name/value pairs
- palettes.primary, palettes.secondary, etc. - Tonal palette entries

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Loop variables:

- loop.index - Current index (0-based)
- loop.first - true if first iteration
- loop.last - true if last iteration

Conditionals

```
<* if {{ loop.first }} *>
/* First item */
<* else *>
/* Other items */
<* endif *>
```

Custom Colors

Define custom colors that generate full M3 token sets:

```
[config.custom_colors]
warning = "#FFA500"
success = { color = "#00FF00", blend = true }
```

Each generates 6 tokens: {name}, on_{name}, {name}_container, on_{name}_container, {name}_source, {name}_value

Special Tags

Tag	Description
{{image}}	Path to source wallpaper image

Examples

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Template (~/.config/noctalia/templates/neovim.lua):

```
return {  
  bg = "{{colors.surface.default.hex}}",  
  fg = "{{colors.on_surface.default.hex}}",  
  accent = "{{colors.primary.default.hex}}",  
  error = "{{colors.error.default.hex}}",  
  warning = "{{colors.tertiary.default.hex}}",  
}
```

Config:

```
[templates.neovim]  
input_path = "~/.config/noctalia/templates/neovim.lua"  
output_path = "~/.config/nvim/lua/colors/noctalia.lua"
```

CSS Variables

Template (~/.config/noctalia/templates/vars.css):

```
:root {  
  <* for name, value in colors *>  
    --{{name | kebab_case}}: {{value.default.hex}};  
  <* endfor *>  
}
```

Troubleshooting

Templates Not Working

- **Check file paths** - Use absolute paths or ~ for home directory

- **Validate TOML syntax** - Use a TOML validator
- **Check logs** - Run Noctalia from terminal to see error messages

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Colors Look Wrong

- **Check mode** - Ensure you're using default, dark, or light correctly
- **Verify color names** - Check spelling matches the available colors

Theme Not Updating

- **Trigger regeneration** - Change any color scheme setting
 - **Check post_hook** - Ensure reload commands are correct
-

Getting Help

- Visit our [GitHub Issues](#)
- Join our [Discord](#) community

Share Your Templates

Created a great template? Share it with the community on Discord!